Conestogo Public School – Council Minutes: Wednesday, January 19, 2022

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UPCOMING COUNCIL EVENTS

2021-2022 Event Dates:

Next Council Meeting: February 16

- March 23 (Adjusted FOR MARCH BREAK)
- April 20
- May 18
- June 15

ACTION ITEM SUMMARY

Initiative/Project	Action Item	Person Responsible

WELCOME & GENERAL BUSINESS

Attendance

(P present, N absent/regrets. Parent Members must attend 70% of meetings to maintain voting privileges.)

Role	2020-2021	Sep 29	Nov 3	Nov 17	Jan 19	Feb 16	Mar 23	Apr 20
Co-Chair	Colleen Heinrichs	P	P	P	P			
Co-Chair	Rebecca Hallman	P	P	P	P			
Treasurer	Karen Hofbauer	P	P	P	P			
Communications	Jenny Benham	P	N	N	P			
Communications	Gena Braun	P	P	P	N			
Secretary	Ian Howlett	P	P	P	P			
Principal	Michael Sendrea	P	P	P	P			
Teacher Reps	Various Staff	Shannon Brown	Dougall Newport	N/A	Taylor Lacey			
Community	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a				
WRAPSC	Jessica Gordon	P	P	N	P			
Parent Members & Volunteers	Cori Algeier	P	N	N	N			
	Christine Sanchez	P	N	P	N			
	Erin Schmidt	P	P	P	P			
	Lynn Ferguson	P	N	N	N			
	Agnes Lehtonen	N	N	N	N			
	Karen Forsyth	P	P	N	P			
	Steph Forte	N	P	P	P			
	Sheri Albert	N	P	N	N			
	Katie Misener	N	N	P	N			
	Juli Oitment	N	N	N	P			

Agenda – Review & Approval

Adjustments to Agenda: •	**Agenda approval with changes motioned by:** **1st: Karen** **2nd: Rebecca**

Minutes, November – Review & Approval

Adjustments to Minutes: •	**Minutes approval with changes motioned by:** **1st: Jessica** **2nd: Rebecca**

PRESENTATIONS

Teacher's Report – Ms. Lacey

- Teachers are grateful to be back to in person learning
- Online learning was challenging
- Kids have adjusted to being back in class very quickly
- **Question**: What is the Kindergarten experience online?
    - K have a different set of minutes than primary (100 minutes)
    - Morning meet with all the students
    - Lessons and games synchronously
    - Difficult to have K students be independent with a computer for synchronous learning

Principal's Report – Mr. Sendrea

- Online from Jan 4-14 by order of the Minister of Education
- A number of changes to the way the school responds to Covid-19 cases
    - No longer reporting on numbers specifically
    - When there is a case in the school, the principal is no longer responsible for communicating to families
    - There are active cases right now but no reporting due to the changes
    - RAT were previously online for asymptomatic cases and are no valid for symptomatic cases

- Temporary virtual learning is also in place from the board
    - Different from online learning
    - Students remain on roster, but similar to being on holidays
    - Less access to one-on-one teachers
    - No assessment on work
    - Students can access the temporary learning and continue to have access on Google Classroom as well
    - Parents can email to the school
- Ministry is taking extra measures on Covid-19 and is sending RAT tests home with students
- Teachers are receiving N95 (non-fitted)
- PCR tests are also being delivered to the school to be sent home if needed
- Vaccination statuses are not made privy to the school
- Students were given awards for their work on making posters for the Legion
    - Students received gold, silver, etc. medals for their work
- Kindergarten registration is happening presently
    - If you know anyone that has a child born in 2017-2018 let them know that Kindergarten registration is open
- Retirement starts on January 31st
    - No replacement named at this point, but hopefully by Monday January 24th
    - It is possible a temporary resource may be put in place until a permanent resource is put in place
- Question: Why did we have asynchronous learning on the Snow Day vs a regular online day?
    - A snow day would normally happen in the middle of learning, so preparing for a Snow Day isn't always possible
    - This would be a good question to bring up to WRAPSC
- Question: Based on the messaging around masks presented at the beginning of the year, can we assume that all students who are unmasked moving forward have a written exemption?
    - There is an exemption process for medical, developmental, and other (human rights) and all students should have that in place

STANDING AGENDA ITEMS

WRAPSC Report – Jessica

- WRAPSC has been busy talking to the Board about parent concerns
- Most recent meeting was discussing the issues with the Board's handling of Halloween

  - In the pursuit of equity, we can sometimes try and take the route of nothing
- The Board was asked what is going to happen with Grad ceremonies in the future
  - Gifts will school logs will not be allowed any longer (already in place)
- Discussions around spreading of fundraising funds across schools
- Business and Education Partners of Waterloo was presented to show different opportunities for careers for students (targeted Grade 7 and above)
  - https://www.wrdsb.ca/trustees/become-a-delegate/
- Also discussing alternative paths to Secondary Education for students
- Next meeting is discussing Social Media in relation to parent council
- Question: What equity issue was the Board trying to solve with the Halloween changes?
  - The board did a survey of highschool students of what percentage of students were interested in celebrating Halloween in the school
  - 87% of students said they would be in favour and 13% was opposed
  - Board wanted to ensure students were not harmed
- Our Trustee can always be reached out to for more information or questions
  - Karen Meissner
  - MUNICIPALITY: Woolwich / Wellesley
  - PHONE: 519-591-2825
  - EMAIL: karen_meissner@wrdsb.ca

Treasurer's Report – Karen

- Very little change on the accounts
- Additional amount was deposited for Mabel's Labels, Silent Auction and other items

Safe, Caring, Inclusive, and Healthy Schools Committee – Mr. Sendrea

- No change in that, will be handed off to the incoming Principal

COMMITTEES & EVENTS – STATUS REPORTS

Fundraising for 2021-2022 – Fundraising Committee

- No updates on the Fundraising committee with the break for the holidays

Virtual Auction Update - Erin

- Went well and raised over $4000

- Thank yous have been sent out the donors

Playground Update – Rebecca, Colleen, Katie

- A meeting was set up with the school board representative and was very happy with the council/school's research and communication
- We asked the Board to fund part of the playground and they were open to it as long as we could create a proposal
- A new quote was sent out for and came back much higher than previous due to supply chain issues, but was attached the new proposal and sent off to the Board
- We are now waiting to hear back from the School Board as to whether they can cover the gap in our funding
- We want to ensure we have something in place for this Spring and will consider going out in the community to cover the funding gap where we can

OPEN DISCUSSION ITEMS

ADJOURNMENT

Motioned by:
1st: Jenny
2nd: Steph